



Macbook notch for AirDrop

AirDrop will come up with a neat shortcut to utilise the notch on Macs.
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Tesla price hike

Tesla's Model 3, S, Y and X are seeing an increase in prices.
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Xiaomi Pad 5

Heavy on features, light on pocket

The Xiaomi Pad 5 is packed with features to the brim and carries a reasonable price tag.

It marks Xiaomi's return to the tablet space in India after 8 long years and aims to offer a premium tablet experience rivalling Apple iPads. Does it have enough potential to be considered as an alternative to the mighty iPad? Let's find out in this review.

BUILD AND DESIGN

The Xiaomi Pad 5 has a premium build and feels great to hold. The middle frame is made from aluminium while the rear panel is largely plastic. The Pad 5 is thinner than the iPad (9th gen) at 6.9mm but is slightly hefty at 511g.

It has four speakers, two at the top and two at the bottom. The power button does not have an embedded fingerprint reader which we feel is a missed opportunity for Xiaomi. There is a magnetic connector to dock the Smart Pen and a three-pin pogo connector to attach the Keyboard.

DISPLAY

The Pad 5 has a gorgeous and high-resolution 10-bit display even though it uses an LCD panel, the visuals are sharp with good contrast and details that make for a great viewing experience. The screen is certified for Dolby Vision and HDR10 playback. Xiaomi claims 650 nits brightness in High Brightness Mode which we found to be accurate. In our tests, the display goes up to 635 nits on average in high brightness mode (Sunlight Mode) and around 630 nits in the normal mode. It also has a colour temperature sensor which adjusts colours based on the ambient lights.

PERFORMANCE

The general day-to-day performance of the Pad 5. From MIUI for Pad to system animations and multitasking, the Pad 5 is excellent for playing games and



doing some work on the side. It offers solid performance across the board and is capable of sustaining it for a long time. The Snapdragon 860 is capable of lending enough power for tasks like sketching, taking notes, editing photos and gaming or watching content on the go. In synthetic benchmarks like AnTuTu, Geekbench, 3DMark and more, the Pad 5 received decent scores. Being a tablet with a large surface area, heat dissipation isn't a problem and this tablet rarely runs hot. It runs intensive games like Genshin Impact, COD Mobile and BGMI without breaking a sweat though.

MIUI for Pad gives it a neat and minimal look. Our hope is that Xiaomi will continue to improve MIUI for Pad especially since the Android 12 update is due which brings in much better support for large screens. Xiaomi is offering a Smart Pen and a Keyboard dock as separate accessories with the Pad 5. The Smart Pen isn't as polished as the Apple Pencil (2nd gen) but offers great pressure sensitivity levels. The Keyboard remains unavailable at the time of writing this review.

CAMERAS

The Pad 5 has a 13MP rear camera which is decent and does a good job of scanning documents and sharing them when required. However, it's not going to be a first choice for taking pictures for anyone who has a smartphone in their pocket. The front-facing camera is also good enough for video calls and it manages to put across sharp visuals with natural skin tones.

BATTERY LIFE

The Xiaomi Pad 5 has a pretty large battery. In our use, you could go on for a day or two of using the Pad 5 regularly. In our video loop test, the Xiaomi Pad 5 ran a local 4K video file over VLC for around 14.5 hours. This was with the brightness set to max and refresh rate set to 120Hz, which is pretty good. Though the Pad 5 supports 33W fast charging, Xiaomi bundles a 22.5W adapter in the box.



BUILD/DESIGN	80
FEATURES	78
PERFORMANCE	79
VALUE FOR MONEY ..	90

VERDICT

Xiaomi is back in the tablet space and how! It sets a benchmark with its Xiaomi Pad 5 which has tons of features but is light on the pocket. The Xiaomi Pad 5 is a solid showing from the company but it

does have its fair share of drawbacks. The Pad 5 misses out on cellular connectivity, GPS, biometric fingerprint reader and a 3.5mm headphone jack. However, we can see Pad 5 being used by college students and creative pros who want to try their hands at sketching and designing.

—Siddharth Chauhan

SPECIFICATIONS

DISPLAY: 10.95-inch LCD, 2560x1600 pixels, Gorilla Glass 3 coating, 650 nits | THICKNESS: 6.9mm | WEIGHT: 511g | STYLUS: Yes, Xiaomi Smart Pen | PLATFORM: Qualcomm Snapdragon 860 | RAM: 6GB | BUILT-IN STORAGE: 128GB/256GB | USB-C: Yes | 3.5MM JACK: No | OS: MIUI 13 (Android 11) | REAR CAMERA: 13MP (f/2.0) | REAR CAMERA VIDEO: 4K (30FPS), 1080p (30FPS) | FRONT CAMERA: 8MP (f/2.0) | SPEAKERS: Quad Stereo speakers | BATTERY AND CHARGING: 8,720mAh, 22.5W charging adapter | COLOURS: Cosmic Gray

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